Slay the Spire 2 Review

Ok so I MIGHT have told some folks I'd be writing about CS but I've been #busy doing other things so this cycle's blog will be a short and chill review on this game I've put ~26 hours in as of writing this.

TL;DR

Game is like Slay the Spire 1 so if you already have that game then there are only 2 reasons to buy Slay the Spire 2:

1. You want to play co-op
2. You want to see the 2 new classes get developed throughout the Early Access

If you DON'T have Slay the Spire 1 then I would recommend the game if you enjoy one or more of these game design choices:

- Roguelike deck building
- Offline Singleplayer PvE
- Addition
- Maps
- Enemies that tread the line between frustrating and challenging
- Paying $25 for the game

With that out of the way I'll mostly be talking about things I liked and didn't like about the game. From this point onward I assume you've at least seen gameplay footage of either Slay the Spire game.

Things I Liked

The new classes, cards, enchantments, and treasures are super fun to play around with especially when the ***stars*** align…

Co-op in general has been really fun to play especially when you get to cook Flaming Hot Cheeto Boneless Wings™. On a more serious note I really like how co-op basically solves some of the complaints listed in the next section since you can basically work with your team to cover for each other's hard counters.

My favorite part in the game was 100% when my co-op squad managed to sacrifice me during a random event and we ended up entering the next encounter down a player. If you were one of the people impacted by the -17HP Ironclad then you have to agree it was a generational W.

Outside of that I don't really have much more to say since the base gameplay loop is *really* fun and in my opinion lends itself to long commutes - like a chill flight to Tokyo.

Things I Disliked

They removed the purple character and I can no longer be blasphemous 🥀
On a more serious note my guess is that Watcher was just conceptually too broken when compared to the other classes.

The most direct example is the Angry buff which doubles the Watcher's damage in exchange for taking double damage. While this sounds like a fair trade on paper, the class gimmick is switching between Calm, Angry, and Neutral which basically allows a player to deal double damage with extra mana while still having the luxury of setting up any other win conditions simultaneously. The closest equivalent in Slay the Spire 2 would be a rare card from the Silent which lets them deal double damage the ***next*** turn while also discarding their whole hand - two massive limitations.

Even ignoring the main class gimmick the Watcher had some pretty insane cards with the highlights including getting an extra turn for free, taking 1 damage from everyone while dealing triple damage, dealing 50 damage at the end of each turn, and essentially having a better version of Necrobinder's doom.

My ending statement here is a plea to the devs for my blasphemous goat to return…

It definitely feels like they took monster gimmicks from Slay the Spire 1 and made them much more annoying. The 2 examples that stick out in my head are the bug that steals a card from your deck and the Experiment boss in Act 3…

While there were gimmicks in Slay the Spire 1 that rewarded certain deck styles more than others it's kind of wild just how much more brutal Slay the Spire 2 can be with the most obvious examples being the Smoggy debuff and Damage Cap buffs (slippery and those stupid bugs that only take max 9 damage and that miniboss that ALSO only takes a max damage).

Something else I noticed was that they removed the Artifact buff as an option from the player and at this point I'm sure it's because they think it's a "lazy" way to play around certain encounters. While there is merit to that argument I feel like the overall powercreep makes this decision feel strange…